The Sun

The Sun is classified as a yellow dwarf star and is the largest object in our Solar System. At the centre of our Solar System, all the planets within, orbit around the Sun. The Sun and the Solar System orbit around the centre of the Milky Way Galaxy. The Sun is over 4.5 billion years old and began as nothing more than a cloud of dust and gas.

Size and Appearance

The Sun is approximately 1.4 million kilometres wide and makes up more than ninety nine percent of the Solar System's mass. In comparison to Earth, the Sun is 109 times wider and could fit approximately 1.3 million Earth's inside of it. Appearing as the colour yellow, the Sun is white however appears yellow through the Earth's atmosphere.

What is the sun made of?

Unlike Earth, the Sun does not have a solid mass and identifiable boundaries. Instead, the Sun is made up of hot gases including hydrogen and helium that collide with each other in the core and let out energy. This process is known as 'nuclear fusion'. As a result, this energy moves to the surface, known as the stratosphere and leaves it as light and heat. The Sun is a barren place, unsuitable for life.

The Sun's Energy

The Sun is responsible for all the biological and physical processes on Earth. It gives almost all the light, heat and vital energy needed for life on Earth. Plants need sunlight to grow, which in turn, provide food to humans and animals, necessary for their survival. The heat it produces warms the oceans, generates weather patterns and stirs the atmosphere. The Sun is a renewable and sustainable source of energy known as solar energy. The Sun's light reaches Earth in approximately eight minutes.

The Sun is a powerful star, essential for life on Earth. For thousands of years, many cultures believed and worshipped the Sun as a god, the most powerful force in the universe. Today, the Sun's potential is still being explored by scientists though space exploration.

Fun Fact: The Sun has a surface temperature of over 6000 degrees Celsius. At the core, the temperature is said to be approximately 15 million degrees Celsius!

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